01 · BEFORE

The old ladder: proof by quota

Sales leader

PROOF a team that hits its number

AE

PROOF quota closed

SDR

PROOF meetings booked

> Max Freeman: Ramp's first SDR, now SVP of Sales.

Source: GTM Intelligence: AI Night event page (Luma), 2026.

02 · AFTER

Same ladder, a forked first rung

Sales leader

PROOF a team that hits its number

AE

PROOF quota closed

SDR

MUCH OF THE MARKET

Agents take templated outbound first; judgment-heavy junior work holds up better.

RAMP

SDRs 50 → 90
AEs 50 → 100+

in one year (vendor-reported)

Sources: Landbase analysis via Stacker, 2026; Actively AI customer case study, 2026.

Alex Yedi

Three places to prove you can sell

The seat

PROOF

A meeting quota over quarters

COSTS

A salary and a manager

The work sample

PROOF

A real job task scored on a rubric, with a human making the call (MeritFirst)

OPEN RISK

An LLM can do a take-home, so the task has to be live or probed

The build

PROOF

Shipped tooling, e.g. Mo, a real-time call copilot built by a Ramp AE that won a Ramp hackathon

OPEN QUESTION

Does building predict selling?

Sources: 8VC, "Introducing MeritFirst," 2025; GTM Intelligence event page, 2026.

What does the first seat test now?

- Talent pipeline?
- New unit economics?
- Scale luxury?

TONIGHT

Max Freeman (Ramp) × Zack Ganieany (MeritFirst)